

JABALPUR ENGINEERING COLLEGE

JEC Alumni Connect

One place for every JECian: profiles, batches, circles and messages.

Product, design and implementation plan

Version 2.0 • October 2026

Prepared by the student development team for the JEC alumni committee.
For discussion. Not an official document of the college.

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What's new in version 2.0

Version 1.1 added the zero budget, interest circles and channels, invites, engagement features and the UI/UX section. Version 2.0 keeps all of that and makes the plan ready to build.

Area	Upgrade in v2.0	Section
Networking	New M8 Connections and follows (LinkedIn-style connect, Instagram-style follow) and "I can help with" tags on every profile, so students find the right senior fast	06, 07
Messages	Message requests for non-connections, daily limits and a "who can message me" setting, so busy alumni are never flooded	07
Verification	The three routes defined in detail: college records, two vouches, or a document checked by a batch admin; read-only access while waiting	06
Journeys	Step-by-step journeys with timings that prove the 3-minute sign-up target	12
Tech	A concrete stack (React PWA + Supabase), an architecture diagram, engineering rules and weekly backups	14
Free limits	Real free-plan limits per service, email sending through Brevo, photo overflow to Cloudflare R2, and the Supabase inactivity pause handled	13
Play Store	Plans for Google's rule that new developer accounts must run a 14-day closed test with 12 testers	18
Law	Members 18+ at launch, a grievance contact, data download and deletion under the DPDP Act	11
Committee	Every decision now has a "needed by" week, plus logo use, college records, admins, guidelines and pilot batches	23
Continuity	A handover plan so the app survives when the founding students graduate	21
Wireframes	Four screens: interest picker, profile, communities and invite	05

JEC has thousands of alumni across India and the world, but no single place where they can find each other, help students, or stay connected with their batch. JEC Alumni Connect is that place.

It combines three things people already know how to use:

- **A professional profile, like LinkedIn:** where you studied at JEC, what you do now, where you work, and what you can help with.
- **Communities, like WhatsApp groups and Instagram:** every member automatically joins their batch (for example "CSE 2016"), can post publicly to all of JEC, and can join interest circles such as travel, trekking, yoga or startups.
- **Direct messages:** any verified student or alumnus can message any other, with limits that stop spam.

What makes it work

Principle	What it means in practice
Trusted	Only verified JECians get in. Three verification routes (Section 06).
Never empty	Launch batch by batch, with invites, progress bars and batch champions (Sections 09, 19).
Fast and beautiful	Sign up in under 3 minutes and message a batchmate within 5. A design lead approves every screen (Section 05).
Almost free	Runs entirely on free plans. The only real cost is a one-time ₹2,100 Google Play fee (Section 13).
Safe	Built for India's data protection law (DPDP Act 2023): consent, privacy controls, block and report, account deletion (Section 11).

At a glance

Item	Plan
Platforms	Web app installable on any phone or PC (PWA), Android app on the Play Store, iPhone via the installed web app in year one
First launch	11 modules: sign-up, verification, profiles, directory and search, connections, messages, feed, batch groups, interest circles and channels, invites, engagement
Time to launch	About 14 weeks, starting with 3 weeks of design and user testing
Team	6 to 9 students, 1 design lead, 1 alumni advisor
Running cost	₹0 per month. One-time ₹2,100 for the Play Store (sponsorship requested)

Why this app, and what success looks like

The problem

- Alumni are spread across WhatsApp groups, LinkedIn and personal contacts. Most groups cover one batch or one branch, and many alumni are in none.
- Students have no easy way to find a senior at a particular company or city to ask for guidance, referrals or internships.
- The college has no up-to-date record of where its alumni are, which makes reunions, mentoring and placement support hard.
- Generic platforms (LinkedIn, Facebook) are noisy, are not limited to JECians, and cannot answer "show me everyone from Mechanical 2010 in Pune".

The vision

Every JECian, one tap away. A student in their first year can find a senior at the company of their dreams and message them in under a minute. An alumnus who graduated in 1995 can find their whole batch, see what they are doing, and plan a reunion.

Goals for the first year

Goal	Target
Verified members	5,000 within 12 months of launch
Batch coverage	At least 30% of every batch from the last 20 years on board
Activity	30% of members active every month
Sign-up speed	Median sign-up under 3 minutes; first message within 5 minutes
Help given	500 student-to-alumni conversations about careers in the first year
Cost	₹0 per month in running costs

Who it is for

Four kinds of people use the app. Every feature should clearly help at least one.

Persona	Who they are	What they want	What stops them today
Riya, 2nd-year student	ECE student, wants an internship in chip design	Find seniors in semiconductor firms; ask for advice and referrals	Doesn't know who works where; cold LinkedIn messages go unanswered
Arjun, alumnus (2014)	Product manager in Bengaluru, busy	Stay in touch with batchmates; help juniors without being flooded	Too many WhatsApp groups; afraid of spam
Mr. Verma, senior alumnus (1992)	Retired engineer, less comfortable with apps	Find old friends; attend reunions; give back	Apps feel complicated; small text
Alumni cell / admin	Faculty coordinator and committee members	Verified alumni records; announcements; events	Data is scattered in spreadsheets

Design for Mr. Verma and Riya at the same time. Large tap targets, clear words, no jargon, and a fast path for power users. If a 60-year-old can sign up in 3 minutes, everyone can.

Feature map: 19 modules

Modules are grouped by what they do. "Launch" means it is in the first public release.

Code	Module	Group	Release
M1	Sign-up and onboarding	Identity	Launch
M2	Verification (3 routes)	Identity	Launch
M3	Professional profile	Identity	Launch
M4	Alumni directory and search	Connect	Launch
M5	Home feed and public posts	Community	Launch
M6	Batch communities (auto-join)	Community	Launch
M7	Direct messages	Connect	Launch
M8	Connections and follows	Connect	Launch
M9	Notifications (in-app, push, email digest)	Platform	Launch
M10	Jobs and referrals	Career	V2
M11	Mentorship	Career	V2
M12	Events and reunions	Career and events	V2
M13	College news and "Proud JECians" wall	College pride	V2
M14	Admin and moderation console	Admin	Launch (basic)
M15	Privacy, safety and settings	Admin	Launch
M16	Analytics for the alumni cell	Admin	V2
M17	Interest circles and channels	Community	Launch (core)
M18	Invite and grow	Growth	Launch
M19	Engagement: birthdays, badges, spotlight, more	Growth	Launch (core)

UI/UX: the make-or-break section

If the app is confusing or ugly, people will try it once and leave. Design gets its own owner, its own time in the schedule, and the power to block a release.

The target: a new member finishes signing up in **under 3 minutes** and messages a batchmate **within 5 minutes**. Every design decision is checked against this.

Design principles

Principle	In practice
Familiar, not new	Copy patterns people know: Instagram-style profile header, WhatsApp-style chat, LinkedIn-style experience list. No custom gestures to learn.
One job per screen	Each screen has one main action, shown as the single filled button.
Fast first	Show content instantly (cached), load images later, skeletons instead of spinners. Every screen usable on a ₹10,000 Android phone on 4G.
Progressive profile	Ask only name, batch, branch and interests at sign-up. Ask the rest later with a friendly "profile 60% complete" card.
Readable for all ages	Minimum 16 px body text, 44 px tap targets, high contrast, works with the phone's large-text setting.
Calm by default	Notifications are batched; nothing makes noise unless a person messaged you, replied to you, or invited you.
Bilingual-ready	English first; all text in one strings file so Hindi can be added in V2.

Navigation

Five bottom tabs, always visible: **Home** (feed), **Network** (directory and search), **Groups** (batch, circles, channels), **Chat** (messages) and **Me** (profile, invites, settings). A search bar sits at the top of Home and Network.

Visual identity



JEC Navy #14306B
Primary, headers, buttons



Marigold #F2A33A
Highlights, badges, progress



Teal #1F9D8B
Success, verified, share



Coral #E5594F
Errors, alerts, live



Ink #1D2433
Body text

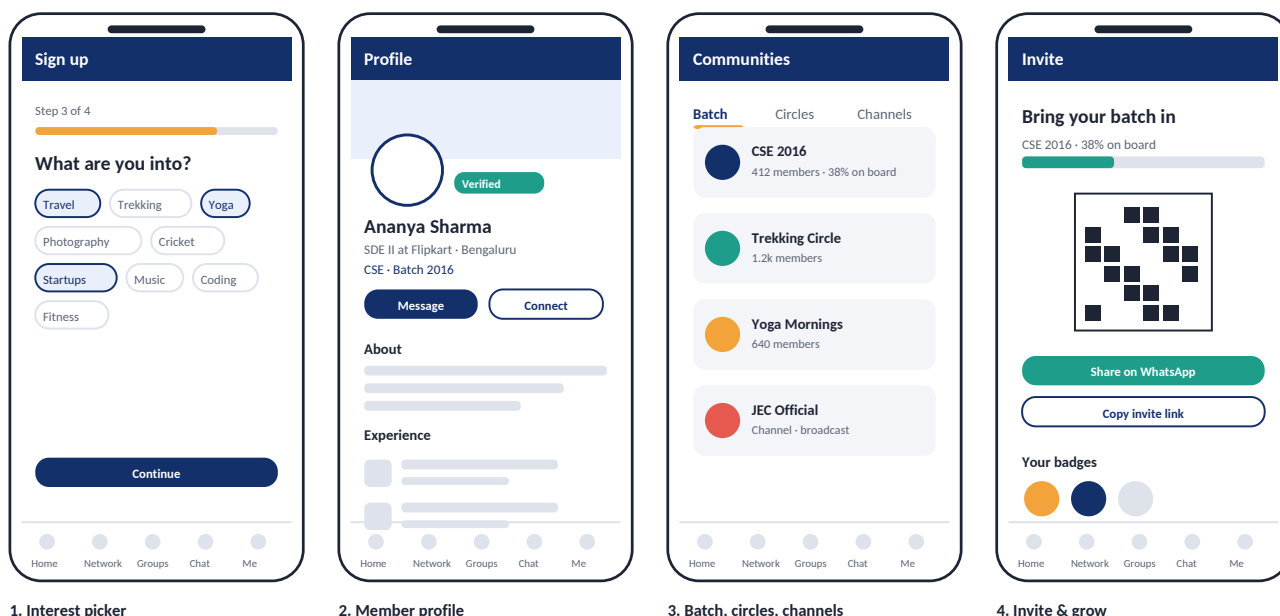


Mist #F3F5F9
Cards, backgrounds

Fonts: Inter for the app interface (free, very readable on small screens), with Noto Sans Devanagari added when Hindi arrives. Type scale: 28 / 22 / 18 / 16 / 14 / 12. **Corners:** 12 px cards, fully rounded buttons and chips. **Icons:** one free set (Lucide), outline style. **Dark mode** from launch, using the same tokens.

Wireframes of key screens

Low-detail layouts to agree on structure. Final visuals come from the Figma prototype.



Design process (weeks 1 to 3, before any feature code)

- **Week 1:** interview 5 alumni and 5 students (15 minutes each) about how they stay in touch today. Map the sign-up, profile, message and invite flows.
- **Week 2:** design system in Figma (free education plan): colours, type, buttons, cards, chips, inputs, empty states. Clickable prototype of the 10 most important screens.
- **Week 3:** test the prototype with 5 alumni (including at least one aged 50+) and 5 students. Time them on sign-up and "message a batchmate". Fix every place where two or more people got stuck. Design lead signs off before coding starts.
- **After launch:** repeat a 5-person test every month; watch where people drop off in sign-up.

Screen checklist: every screen must pass before release

Area	Check
Clarity	One main action; a stranger can say what the screen is for in 5 seconds
States	Designed loading, empty, error and offline states (empty states tell you what to do next)
Access	Text contrast at least 4.5:1; tap targets at least 44 px; works with large text and a screen reader
Speed	Usable within 2 seconds on a mid-range Android phone on 4G
Consistency	Uses only design-system components and tokens; no one-off colours
Words	Plain English, no jargon, buttons say what they do ("Send invite", not "Submit")
Devices	Checked at 360 px phone width, a large phone, and desktop; light and dark mode
Privacy	Shows only what the viewer is allowed to see; private fields never leak into previews

Design lead: one named person owns the design system and approves every UI change. A pull request that changes a screen needs their approval, with a before/after screenshot.

M1 Sign-up and onboarding

Launch

Four short steps, with progress shown at the top. Everything else can be filled in later.

- **Step 1, sign in:** "Continue with Google" (one tap) or email with a 6-digit code. No passwords and no paid SMS.
- **Step 2, JEC details:** I am a student / alumnus / faculty; branch; year of joining and graduation; roll or enrolment number (optional, speeds up verification).
- **Step 3, interests:** pick at least 3 from chips (travel, trekking, yoga, photography, cricket, startups, coding, music and more). This fills circle suggestions.
- **Step 4, photo and headline:** optional, skippable. Then land on a welcome screen showing your batch group and 3 batchmates to say hi to.
- Members must be 18 or older at launch (avoids the extra parental-consent rules for minors).

M2 Verification (3 routes)

Launch

Only verified members can message, post publicly or appear in search. Unverified users can complete their profile and browse their own batch group in read-only mode.

- **Route A, college records (instant):** the name, branch, batch and roll number match the batch lists the college provides. Students can also verify with a college email address, if the college issues one.
- **Route B, vouching (fast):** two verified members confirm "I know this person from JEC". An invite from a verified member counts as one vouch.
- **Route C, documents (fallback):** upload a degree, marksheet or college ID. A batch admin checks it within 48 hours. The file is deleted after the decision.
- A "Verified" badge shows on profiles. Faculty are verified by the alumni cell.

M3 Professional profile

Launch

Like LinkedIn, but built around JEC. A strong profile is what makes people want to connect.

- **Header:** photo, cover, name, headline ("SDE II at Flipkart"), branch and batch, city, verified badge, and buttons for Message and Connect.
- **Sections:** About; Experience (company, role, years); Education (JEC plus others); Skills; Achievements; links (LinkedIn, GitHub, website).
- **"I can help with" tags:** referrals, mock interviews, higher studies, startups, guidance for juniors. These power search and later mentorship.
- Interests and circles, badges earned, and the member's recent posts.
- Each field has a visibility setting: everyone at JEC, my batch, connections, or only me. Phone and email are hidden by default.
- Profile completeness meter with one suggestion at a time.

Connect: directory, search, connections, messages

M4 Alumni directory and search

[Launch](#)

The core reason to open the app: "find JECians who...".

- Search by name, company, role, skill or city, tolerant of spelling mistakes.
- Filters: branch, batch year (range), city, country, company, industry, "can help with", student/alumni/faculty.
- Smart lists on the Network tab: your batchmates, people in your city, people at your company, people who share your interests, seniors who offer referrals.
- Batch view: a grid of everyone in a batch, with a progress bar of how many have joined.
- V2: map view of alumni by city.

M7 Direct messages

[Launch](#)

Familiar WhatsApp-style chat, built so busy alumni are never flooded.

- 1:1 text messages, photos and links; typing indicator; read receipts (can be turned off).
- **Message requests:** a message from someone you are not connected to lands in Requests. You can accept, ignore, or block and report.
- Limits: a new member can start at most 10 new conversations a day; the limit rises with trust.
- "Who can message me" setting: everyone at JEC, my batch and connections, or connections only.
- V2: small group chats (up to 50) and message search.

M8 Connections and follows

[Launch](#)

Two light ways to build a network.

- **Connect** (two-way, needs acceptance): you appear in each other's network and can always message each other.
- **Follow** (one-way): see someone's public posts without a request; useful for well-known alumni.
- Batchmates are suggested first; "people you may know" uses batch, branch, city and interests.

M9 Notifications

[Launch](#)

Useful, never noisy.

- In-app inbox for everything; push notifications only for messages, replies, connection requests, invites accepted and birthdays of connections.
- Weekly email digest (opt-in): what happened in your batch and circles.
- Per-type switches and a "quiet hours" setting.

Community: feed, batches, circles, channels

Space	Who joins	Who can post	Example
Public feed	Everyone	Any verified member	"Got into IIM Ahmedabad! Thanks to my seniors"
Batch group	Automatic, by branch and year (plus an all-branches year group)	Members of that batch	CSE 2016; JEC 2016 (all branches)
Interest circle	Anyone who chooses to	Any member of the circle	Trekking, Yoga Mornings, Startups
Channel	Anyone can follow	Only channel admins (broadcast)	JEC Official, Placement Updates

M5 Home feed and public posts

[Launch](#)

Where people see what JECians are doing.

- Post types: text, up to 4 photos, link preview, poll. Like, comment, share to chat, save.
- Choose an audience for every post: all of JEC, my batch, or a circle.
- Feed mixes posts from your batch, your circles, your connections and public posts, newest first, with pinned announcements on top. Smarter ranking can come later.
- Report any post; posts with several reports are hidden until a moderator reviews them.

M6 Batch communities

[Launch](#)

Every member joins their batch automatically. This is the reason most alumni will first open the app.

- Two groups per member: branch batch ("CSE 2016") and whole-year batch ("JEC 2016").
- Batch feed, member list with "not yet joined" count, and pinned posts by batch admins.
- Two or three volunteer **batch admins** per batch: approve verifications, pin posts, moderate.
- Reunion planning and photo albums arrive with Events in V2.

M17 Interest circles and channels

[Launch \(core\)](#)

Connects JECians across batches through what they enjoy, not only when they graduated.

- **Circles** are groups where everyone can post: travel, trekking, yoga, photography, cricket, running, startups, coding, music, books, higher studies abroad, UPSC/GATE and more.
- The team creates 15 starter circles; members can propose new ones, which an admin approves.
- Members can create city circles ("JECians in Pune").
- **Channels** are broadcast-only, like WhatsApp channels: JEC Official, Placement Updates, Alumni Cell, each with named admins. Followers can react but not post.
- **V2, trip plans:** a circle member posts a trip (dates, place, cost share, seats); others tap "I'm in"; a group chat is created for those going.
- **V3, fitness challenges:** "30 days of yoga" or "100 km in October", with daily check-ins, streaks and circle leaderboards.

Grow and engage: invites, badges, birthdays

An alumni app is only as good as who is on it. Growth is a feature, not an afterthought.

M18 Invite and grow

Launch

Turn every member into a recruiter for their batch, without ever spamming anyone.

- Each member gets a personal invite link and QR code, with one-tap sharing to WhatsApp and a ready-made message.
- Invite anyone from any batch: a senior, a junior or a whole group of close friends at once (share one link to a WhatsApp group).
- An invite from a verified member counts as one vouch, so the friend gets verified faster.
- **Batch progress:** "CSE 2016: 38% on board", shown in the batch group and on the invite screen, with milestone celebrations at 25%, 50% and 75%.
- **Badges:** Connector (5 friends joined), Batch Champion (25 joined), Founding Member (joined in the first month). Leaderboards for top inviters per batch and branch vs branch.
- **No-spam promise:** the app never messages invitees itself. Reminders such as "3 of your invites haven't joined yet" go only to the person who invited them.
- *Decision needed:* may verified members see the names of batchmates who haven't joined (from college records), so they know whom to invite? See Section 23.

M19 Engagement features

Launch (core)

Small reasons to come back every week.

- **At launch:** birthday reminders for your connections and batch, with one-tap wishes; badges for profile complete, first post, helpful answers and invites; "**JECian of the Week**" spotlight chosen by the alumni cell from nominations.
- **V2:** "Ask JEC" Q&A; forum (questions tagged by topic, answers upvoted, best answer marked); city-wise blood donation and help network (members opt in with blood group and city; requests go only to opted-in members nearby); directory of alumni-run businesses with JECian offers.
- **V3:** 24-hour stories; quizzes about JEC; "Throwback Thursday" old-photo posts; anniversary messages ("10 years since you graduated!").

M10 Jobs and referrals

V2

Alumni post openings at their companies; students and alumni apply or ask for referrals.

- Job post: role, company, location, experience, link or "ask me for a referral".
- Filters by role, location, experience, internship or full-time; save jobs; get alerts.
- Referral requests go to the poster as a structured message with the applicant's profile.
- Placement Updates channel for the college's training and placement cell.

M11 Mentorship

V2

Structured help from seniors, without flooding them.

- Alumni set what they can help with and how many mentees they can take each month.
- Students send a short request (goal, question); the mentor accepts or declines.
- Office hours: mentors open slots; students book a 20-minute call (video link added by mentor).
- Feedback after each session; "Top Mentor" badge.

M12 Events and reunions

V2

From batch reunions to webinars and city meetups.

- Create an event (online or offline), RSVP, add to calendar, reminders, attendee list.
- Reunion pages with photo albums and a planning chat.
- Annual alumni meet and convocation pages managed by the alumni cell.

M13 College news and Proud JECians

V2

Keep alumni connected to the college itself.

- College news, achievements and campus updates through the JEC Official channel.
- "Proud JECians" wall: notable alumni stories, nominated by members and approved by the cell.
- Later, with committee approval: give-back pages for scholarships or lab projects.

M14 Admin and moderation console

[Launch \(basic\)](#)

Web-only screens for the alumni cell, batch admins and moderators.

- Roles: super admin (alumni cell), moderator, batch admin, channel admin.
- Verification queue (routes B and C), report queue, user search, suspend or ban.
- Upload college batch lists (CSV) for route-A verification.
- Create channels, pin announcements, approve new circles.
- Every admin action is logged (who, what, when).

M15 Privacy, safety and settings

[Launch](#)

Trust is the product. Designed for the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

- Clear consent at sign-up, written in plain language; a privacy policy and terms page.
- Per-field profile visibility; "who can message me"; hide from search.
- Block and report on every profile, post, comment and message.
- Download my data and delete my account (data removed within 30 days).
- Spam limits: new conversations per day, posts per hour, links from new accounts held for review.
- Security: row-level access rules in the database, so the app can never show data a user should not see; all traffic over HTTPS; admin accounts use Google sign-in only.
- A named grievance contact (required by the DPDP Act).

M16 Analytics for the alumni cell

[V2](#)

Simple, privacy-friendly numbers.

- Members by batch, branch, city, country and industry; growth over time.
- Engagement: active members, messages, posts, events, mentorship sessions.
- Exports for the college (only totals; never personal data without consent).

A. New alumnus, invited by a friend (target: under 3 minutes)

Step	What happens	Time
1	Taps the invite link in WhatsApp; the app opens (or the web version, with an install prompt)	10 s
2	"Continue with Google"	15 s
3	Picks Alumnus, branch, batch; the inviter's vouch is applied automatically	40 s
4	Picks 3+ interests	30 s
5	Adds a photo and headline, or skips	45 s
6	Welcome screen: "You're in CSE 2016. 156 batchmates are here." Three suggested people to say hi to	20 s

B. Student looking for a referral

- Network tab, search "Google", filter "can help with: referrals".
- Opens a senior's profile, sees shared branch and city, taps Message.
- The message goes to the senior's Requests with the student's profile card attached; the senior accepts and replies.

C. Verification without college records

- Member signs up without an invite and their roll number isn't on any list yet.
- The app suggests: "Ask 2 batchmates to vouch for you" (share a link), or "Upload a document".
- Meanwhile they can finish their profile and read their batch group.
- Once verified, they get a notification and full access.

Budget: running at almost ₹0

Every service below has a free plan large enough for the first few thousand members. Free limits change, so the team re-checks them before launch.

Need	Service (free plan)	Free allowance (approx.)	Cost
Database, login, file storage, realtime chat, server functions	Supabase	500 MB database, 1 GB files, 50,000 monthly users, 200 live connections	₹0
Sign-in	Google sign-in + email one-time code via Supabase Auth	Unlimited Google sign-ins	₹0
Sending emails (codes, digests)	Brevo SMTP	300 emails a day	₹0
Web hosting	Cloudflare Pages	Unlimited bandwidth, 500 builds a month	₹0
Push notifications	Firebase Cloud Messaging	Unlimited	₹0
Photo storage overflow (later)	Cloudflare R2	10 GB, no download fees (card needed on file)	₹0
Design	Figma (education plan)	Full features for students	₹0
Code, tasks, automated checks	GitHub	Free for public and private repos	₹0
Error tracking, analytics	Sentry free plan; Cloudflare Web Analytics	5,000 errors a month	₹0
Web address	College subdomain (asked) or a free *.pages.dev address	-	₹0
Android app	Google Play developer account	One-time fee	₹2,100
iPhone app	Installable web app (PWA) in year one, instead of the App Store	-	₹0 (saves ₹8,300 a year)

Total: ₹0 a month, plus a one-time ₹2,100 for the Play Store, which we ask an alumnus to sponsor. Until then, everyone (Android included) can use the installable web app.

Rules that keep us inside the free limits

- Compress photos on the phone before upload: profile photos to 400 px (about 50 KB), post photos to 1280 px (about 200 KB), WebP format.
- Load lists in pages of 20; never download a whole table.
- Use live connections only for open chats; everything else refreshes when you open the screen.
- Cache data on the phone so repeat visits don't hit the server.
- Delete verification documents after review; limit posts to 4 photos.

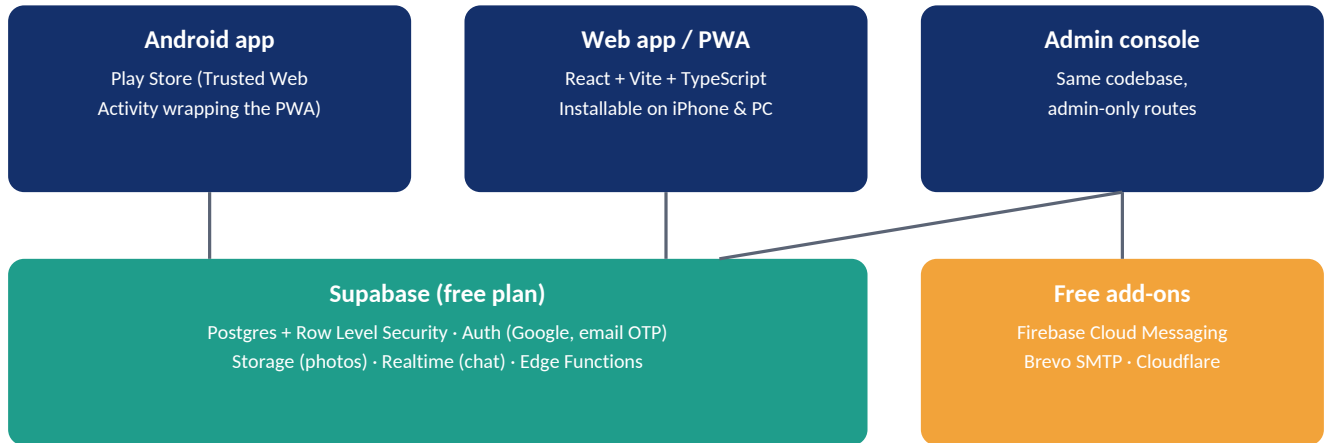
- Keep the project active (a weekly scheduled check), because free Supabase projects pause after a week of no activity.
- Watch usage in a simple dashboard and get an alert at 70% of any limit.

When paying would make sense

Only when real usage demands it: roughly beyond 10,000 active members, more than 1 GB of photos, or a need for daily backups. Supabase Pro costs about US\$25 a month (around ₹2,100). At that scale, alumni sponsorship of hosting is realistic. An Apple developer account (about ₹8,300 a year) is worth it only when many iPhone users ask for a native app.

Technical architecture

One codebase for web, Android and admin. A managed backend so the team writes product, not servers.



Layer	Choice	Why
Frontend	React + Vite + TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, TanStack Query, React Router	Widely known by students; fast; huge free ecosystem
Installable app	PWA with service worker (vite-plugin-pwa); offline cache	Works on iPhone, Android and desktop without stores
Android	Trusted Web Activity built with Bubblewrap / PWABuilder	Puts the same web app on the Play Store; no second codebase
Backend	Supabase: Postgres, Auth, Storage, Realtime, Edge Functions	Free plan, no servers to run, row-level security
Search	Postgres full-text search + trigram matching for names	Fast and typo-tolerant without a paid search service
Push	Firebase Cloud Messaging (web push, works on installed iPhone PWAs, iOS 16.4+)	Free
Quality	ESLint, Prettier, Vitest, Playwright; GitHub Actions on every pull request	Catches bugs before release

Engineering rules

- Every table has row-level security rules; the browser never has admin keys.
- Database changes only through versioned migration files in the repo.
- Separate development and production projects; test data never in production.
- Every pull request: automated checks pass, one code review, and design-lead approval if it changes a screen.
- Weekly database export to private storage (the free plan has no automatic backups).

Main tables for the first launch. V2 adds jobs, mentorship and events.

Table	What it stores
profiles	One row per member: name, photo, headline, role (student/alumnus/faculty), branch, batch, city, about, visibility settings, verification status
experiences, educations, skills	Profile sections
help_tags	"I can help with" tags per member
college_records	Batch lists from the college (admin-only), used for verification
verifications, vouches	Verification requests, route, documents, decisions; who vouched for whom
interests, profile_interests	Interest list and each member's picks
groups	Batches, circles and channels (type, name, rules, visibility)
group_members	Membership and role (member, admin) in each group
posts, post_media, comments, reactions	Feed and group content
connections, follows	Two-way connections and one-way follows
conversations, conversation_members, messages	Direct messages and requests
invites	Invite codes, who invited whom, status
badges, member_badges	Badge definitions and awards
notifications, push_tokens, notification_settings	In-app inbox and push delivery
reports, blocks, admin_actions	Safety and audit trail

About 35 screens at launch. Each goes through the checklist in Section 05.

Area	Screens
Onboarding	Welcome, sign in, email code, JEC details, interests, photo and headline, verification status, welcome to your batch
Home	Feed, create post, post detail with comments, notifications
Network	Search and filters, smart lists, batch grid, connection requests, my connections
Profile	My profile, edit sections, other member's profile, profile completeness
Groups	My groups (batch, circles, channels), group feed, group members, discover circles, propose a circle, channel view
Chat	Conversation list, requests, chat thread, media viewer
Grow	Invite (link, QR, share), my invites, batch progress, badges, leaderboard
Settings	Privacy, notifications, blocked users, download data, delete account, help and report
Admin (web)	Dashboard, verification queue, reports queue, users, college records upload, channels and circles, spotlight

Release scope: Launch, V2, V3

Launch (week 14)	V2 (about 3 months after)	V3 (about 6 months after)
Sign-up and onboarding (M1)	Jobs and referrals (M10)	Stories
Verification, 3 routes (M2)	Mentorship (M11)	Fitness challenges with streaks
Professional profile (M3)	Events and reunions (M12)	Quizzes and throwbacks
Directory and search (M4)	College news, Proud JECians (M13)	Native iPhone app (if needed)
Feed and public posts (M5)	Analytics (M16)	Give-back and scholarship pages (if approved)
Batch groups (M6)	Ask JEC Q&A	Smarter feed ranking
Direct messages (M7)	Blood donation and help network	
Connections and follows (M8)	Alumni business directory	
Notifications (M9)	Trip plans	
Admin console, basic (M14)	Group chats, message search	
Privacy and safety (M15)	Hindi language	
Circles and channels (M17)	Map view	
Invites, badges, leaderboards (M18)		
Birthdays, badges, JECian of the Week (M19)		

Rule: nothing moves into the launch list unless something of similar size moves out. A smaller app that feels great beats a big one that feels half-built.

Roadmap: 14 weeks to launch

Weeks	Phase	Deliverables
1-3	Design and setup	Interviews, Figma design system and prototype, tested with 5 alumni + 5 students, design sign-off. In parallel: repo, automated checks, Supabase dev project, database schema, request batch lists from the college
4-5	Identity	Sign-up and onboarding, verification (3 routes), profiles, privacy settings, row-level security rules
6-7	Connect	Directory and search, connections and follows, direct messages and requests
8-9	Community	Feed and posts, batch groups, circles and channels, notifications and push
10-11	Grow	Invites, QR, batch progress, badges, leaderboards, birthdays, JECian of the Week. Start Play Store closed testing (12 testers for 14 days are required for new accounts)
12	Admin and hardening	Admin console, reports and moderation, spam limits, accessibility and speed pass, privacy policy, security review
13	Closed beta	One or two batches (about 200 people); fix the top issues; finish Play Store review
14	Public launch	Launch batch by batch (Section 19)

Every two weeks, the team demos working software to the alumni advisor. The roadmap assumes about 15 hours a week per developer alongside classes; exam weeks are planned as lighter weeks.

Launch and growth plan

An empty app dies on day one. We launch batch by batch so every new member finds friends already there.

Stage	Who	How
1. Seed	Committee members, alumni cell, final-year students, 10 batch champions	Personal invites; make sure each pilot batch has 20+ people and some posts before opening
2. Pilot batches	3 to 5 batches with active WhatsApp groups	Batch champions share the invite in their groups; progress bar visible; fix issues fast
3. Decade waves	2015–2025, then 2005–2014, then earlier	Each wave gets a launch post, a JECian of the Week from that decade, and a batch leaderboard
4. Students	All current students	Introduced through the training and placement cell and college clubs, once enough alumni are on board
5. Ongoing	Everyone	Annual alumni meet, convocation, monthly spotlight, mentorship drives

Batch champions

One or two volunteers per batch who invite their batch, welcome newcomers, and act as batch admins. They get the Batch Champion badge and recognition at the annual meet.

Metric	How we measure it	Target
Sign-up time	Median time from first screen to welcome screen	Under 3 minutes
Sign-up completion	Share of people who start and finish sign-up	Above 80%
Time to first message	From sign-up to first message sent	Under 5 minutes for invited members
Verification time	From sign-up to verified	Median under 24 hours
Invite conversion	Invites that turn into verified members	Above 30%
Batch coverage	Share of each batch on the app	30% in launched batches within 6 months
Monthly active	Members active in the last 30 days / all members	Above 30%
Week-4 retention	New members still active 4 weeks later	Above 40%
Help given	Student–alumni conversations with a reply	500 in year one
Running cost	Monthly bills	₹0

Role	People	Responsibilities
Product lead	1	Owns this plan and scope, runs weekly planning, reports to the committee
Design lead	1	Owns the design system and Figma, runs user tests, approves every UI change
Frontend developers	2-3	Screens, PWA, Android packaging, accessibility and speed
Backend developers	1-2	Database, security rules, functions, notifications, search
QA and beta coordinator	1	Test plans, beta group, bug triage, Play Store testing
Community and growth lead	1	Batch champions, launch waves, spotlight, social media
Alumni advisor	1 (alumnus)	Guidance, reviews every two weeks, connects with the committee
Faculty coordinator	1	College records, official channel, approvals from the college

Keeping the app alive after we graduate

- Code, designs and documentation live in an organisation account owned by the alumni cell, not by one student.
- Every year, juniors join the team in the second half and take over before the seniors graduate.
- A handover guide: how to deploy, rotate keys, add admins, and restore a backup.

Risks and how we handle them

Risk	Impact	What we do
App feels empty at launch	High	Batch-by-batch launch, seeding, batch champions, invite rewards
Confusing or ugly UI	High	Design-first process, user testing, design lead, screen checklist
Spam or misuse of messages	High	Verification, message requests, daily limits, block and report, moderation
Privacy breach	High	Row-level security, privacy-by-default, security review, minimal data, DPDP compliance
Free limits exceeded	Medium	Photo compression, pagination, usage alerts at 70%, sponsor plan ready
Team members graduate or get busy	Medium	Documentation, junior pipeline, organisation-owned accounts
College records unavailable	Medium	Vouching and document routes still work
Low alumni activity after sign-up	Medium	Birthdays, spotlight, weekly digest, events, circles
Play Store review delays	Low	Start closed testing in week 10; the web app works meanwhile

Decisions for the alumni committee

We need these answers to stay on schedule. The week shows when each answer is needed.

#	Decision	Why it matters	Needed by
1	Official endorsement: may we use the JEC name and logo, and announce through college channels?	Trust and reach	Week 2
2	Will the college share batch lists (name, branch, year, roll number) for verification?	Instant verification (route A)	Week 4
3	Will the college give a free web address (for example alumni.)?	Credibility, easy to remember	Week 10
4	Will an alumnus sponsor the ₹2,100 Play Store fee?	Android app listing	Week 9
5	Can verified members see the names of batchmates who haven't joined yet (from college records)?	Big boost to invites, but a privacy decision	Week 9
6	Who are the super admins and moderators? Can we appoint batch admins?	Moderation and verification	Week 11
7	Approve the community guidelines and privacy policy	Legal and safety	Week 12
8	Which 3 to 5 batches pilot first?	Launch plan	Week 12

Later, not urgent: should the alumni association register as a society or trust? This only matters if we later accept donations or run scholarships through the app.

Next steps

When	Action	Owner
This week	Share this plan with the team and alumni committee; collect feedback	Product lead
This week	Confirm roles (Section 21), especially the design lead	Team
Week 1	Committee meeting on decisions 1, 2 and 4	Product lead + alumni advisor
Week 1	Start interviews with 5 alumni and 5 students	Design lead
Week 1	Create GitHub organisation, Supabase dev project, Figma team	Backend lead
Week 3	Prototype test and design sign-off	Design lead
Week 4	Start building (Identity phase)	Developers

The one-line summary: a beautiful, trusted, free app where every JECian can build a profile, find and message anyone from JEC, join their batch and interest groups, and bring their friends along.